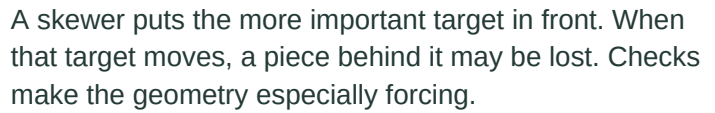


Skewers

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Search ranks, files, and diagonals where two enemy pieces line up. Calculate the first target's legal responses.

The defending king is on e2. Geometrically undefended: rook on a7 and bishop on h5. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Bxd1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on d1. Recorded reply: **27.Ke1**.

27...Bxh5 The bishop captures the bishop on h5.

At the end, nominal material is White 10 / Black 13 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -5 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

The defender may block, capture the attacker, or protect the rear piece while moving the front one. Alignment alone is not enough.